

MIRRORLESS DIGITAL CAMERAS

The hottest category of cameras throw up unique challenges during the buying process

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Mirrorless cameras are largely aimed at casual users and enthusiasts and not professionals, while there are some excellent pro-level mirrorless cameras in the market, they still remain exceptions. Pay attention to the following:

1. SENSOR SIZE

You primarily have two choices when it comes to sensor sizes for mirrorless cameras— the micro four third sensor size and the APS-C sensors. APS-C sensor based mirrorless cameras offer better image quality as compared to a micro four third system based camera purely by virtue of the larger size of the APS-C sensor. With the rapid progress and adoption of APS-C sensors in mirrorless cameras, we recommend you select an APS-C sensor based mirrorless cameras over a micro four third system.

2. FOCUSING ENGINE

While most mirrorless cameras use a contrast detection method to achieve focus lock, the very latest generation of mirrorless cameras have progressed to hybrid focusing systems, offering a combination of phase detect and contrast detect focussing to achieve

accurate and fast focusing in varied light conditions. If you are looking to buy a new mirrorless camera, if budget permits, we recommend you choose a model equipped with a hybrid focusing system.

3. VIEWFINDER

Mirrorless cameras either use the LCD display as a viewfinder to preview and compose shots or they incorporate an EVF (Electronic View Finder) that works like the optical view finder in DSLRs by offering an eye-level view finder for you.

Many mirrorless cameras offer an EVF as an add-on accessory that attaches to the hot shoe port in the camera, providing the option of adding the EVF feature to camera at a later stage. While EVF is a very useful feature to have in a mirrorless camera, the high premium and limited choice in terms of models makes it suitable for a select few who are ready to pay a premium for the benefits of an EVF.

4. FORM-FACTOR

As we mentioned earlier, mirrorless cameras are compact and sit between point and shoots and DSLRs in terms of size and weight. If you are serious about photography

and are wanting to dabble in the art of capturing impactful images, chunky mirrorless cameras with more controls and better grip will do you good, encouraging you to experiment more by virtue of easy and direct access to various settings and manual modes. For a family camera that needs to take good looking shots irrespective of who in the family is using the camera, we recommend buying the non-intimidating compact models if you prefer.

5. LENS SYSTEM

Today, the advantage of a micro four third system with wider availability of lenses is fading rapidly. With Sony and Fujifilm focussing and finding success with their APS-C sensor based mirrorless cameras, the market is almost equally divided and the trend is shifting towards APS-C systems for mirrorless cameras. For example, Sony has 4-5 lens options for their APS-C based mirrorless cameras and beyond that, it's third-party equipment. So, the lack of range and relatively high price remains the Achilles' Heel for mirrorless cameras, perhaps the only real reason why professionals aren't yet ready to ditch their DSLRs just yet. 

TOP

BUDGET ILCS



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PANASONIC LUMIX DMC-GX1W MIRRORLESS WITH 14-42MM + 14MM LENS

An excellent deal for anyone wanting a combination of basic kit lens and a compact pancake lens with a very well built camera that will appeal to the enthusiasts.